

REDCAPS

"What size are those boots, hmm? Go on, tell me. Or I can snap your foot off at the ankle and find out."

The Dreaming is full of nightmares, but redcaps are what fae children fear. Named for the bright red caps they used to dip in the blood of their enemies, redcaps long ago gave up such quaint beginnings. Instead, they embrace their heritage as the kith born out of nightmare itself to become the most terrifying, disgusting, fiercest fae around.

At their hearts, redcaps are rebellious and headstrong, and vicious to anyone they perceive as the ruling body they must oppose. A

redcap is only happy when she is making mortal and Kithain alike recoil in terror or disgust, and while a single redcap can be a disruptive presence in any court, a group of them can become a violent tide not even the wisest ruler can stop. Redcaps only feel understood among their own, and gather in gangs called *corbies*. Each corby carries its own name, and redcaps spread the symbol and name of their gang far and wide to strike fear in their enemies. Come nightfall, anyone in the way of such a nightmarish host ought to get out of the way, unless they'd like to find out what being digested feels like.



Considering their reputations and natures, it's a wonder redcaps haven't overstayed their welcome in changeling society. Yet despite their brutal nature, redcaps are as much a part of fae life as any other kith. They serve as terrific fighters with a dedication to freedom and independence that makes them ferocious allies against common enemies. Those who can stand to get to know redcaps often find that beneath that grotesque exterior beats the heart of an oft-misunderstood redcap, simply seeking a place to belong among others like them. Still, getting beneath their exterior is difficult, and many redcaps embrace their darker natures, becoming the shadow counterpoint to the Seelie Court's noble warriors.

Their vicious and upstart nature keeps redcaps out of the politics of court life, but they're widely known for sowing dissent and unrest in the name of standing up for themselves and their kith. Only the most patient redcaps work within the system, and often end up destabilizing things from within, just on principle. Only the strongest of fae can keep a redcap down, and never for very long. Eventually, a bound redcap shakes itself free, and then the true mayhem begins.

Appearance: Redcaps come in all shapes and sizes, but all share the same gray, rubbery skin, blood-shot eyes and yellowing, uneven teeth. Their bodies are often thick, with stocky shoulders and legs. And who can forget their signature mouth, full of blood-red gums and razor-sharp teeth, ready to rip apart flesh and grind bone? Redcaps dress in rough and ready clothing, and always sport a splash of that terrifying red in their wardrobe.

Lifestyles: Anything tough and dangerous is a good job for a redcap. Many live and work in the worst parts of cities, and stick with their corbies for maximum terror in one place. Redcaps look for work anywhere they can throw a couple of elbows and create mayhem, as bouncers, private security, gang members, and hired muscle. The Unseelie pays well for leg breakers and, though it's not an exclusive arrangement, many redcaps survive thanks to busting heads for the Unseelie.

Childling: Redcap childlings are the horrible tiny terrors, the young misanthropes that try and gross out the other kids by eating something they shouldn't. While a childling, a redcap learns just how far she can push her luck before both mortals and

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